to it but also a procurement side. The Defence Procurement Manual (DPM) and the Delegation of Financial Powers to the Defence Services (DFPDS) became my new companions. The requirements were complex and the canvas quite wide. For example, the procurement of all IT hardware and software for the entire Indian Army was compiled by the DGIS. The formulation of the plan would commence by July each year and after being vetted by the Integrated Financial Adviser (IFA), promulgated by March the following year, just before the start of the new financial year. The IT PPP would run into over 100 pages with a proposed outlay running into thousands of crores. It was a daunting and challenging task.

Another MIS that was being developed was the ARPAN software, the Army Record Office Process Automation programme aimed at the digitization of all the Records Offices of the Army, something that I had observed during my tenure at the Regimental Centre. It was being developed jointly by the Army Software Development Centre (ASDC) and Tech Mahindra, using state-of-the-art web-based technology. It had been under development for some time, but many glitches remained unaddressed. Tech Mahindra had won the contract after a very competitive bidding process and due to the way the contract had been worded, they were not getting any payment either. We were asking for some of the add-ons which the company felt were beyond the terms of the original contract. Our view was that these add-ons being asked for were beyond the control of the Army and were only in pursuance of government orders. For example, the government had made Aadhaar mandatory only recently, but it was not there when the programme commenced. To make this inclusion would require many manhours of effort. There was a stalemate and the development of version 3.0 was being stalled.

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